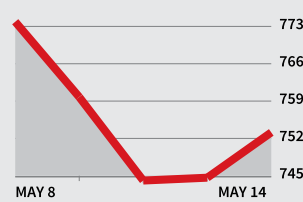


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 75398.72 (+789.74)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23689.60	+277.00
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.40	+0.22
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.76	+0.06
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	160514.00	+182
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	287193.00	-527

IN A DILEMMA.

Pesticide makers' body

CroLife India seeks a balanced approach in response to ban on Paraquat **p10**



MAKING A BOND.

India considering reduction in taxes paid by foreign investors on the nation's bonds **p7**

QUICKLY.

TAKING THE REINS

VD Satheesan is Congress pick for Kerala CM



Thiruvananthapuram/

New Delhi: The Congress ended days of uncertainty over the Kerala chief ministership, announcing VD Satheesan as leader of the Congress Legislature Party after a prolonged internal struggle, in which the top leadership weighed competing claims till almost the very last minute. **p8**

PRICEY FUEL

WPI inflation at 42-month high of 8.3% in April

New Delhi: With a rise in fuel prices, inflation based on the Wholesale Price Index surged to a 42-month high of 8.3 per cent in April. It was 3.88 per cent in March. "Positive rate of inflation in April is due to increase in prices of mineral oils, crude petroleum and natural gas, basic metals, other manufacturing and non-food articles," said the Commerce Ministry. **p3**

Inox Clean buys US solar assets of China's Boway Group for \$750 m

SUNSHINE DEAL. Marks firm's manufacturing entry into US, second overseas acquisition

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Inox Clean Energy Ltd, INOXGFL Group's renewable energy arm, has acquired the US solar manufacturing assets of Boviet Solar Technology LLC, part of China's Boway Group, for about \$750 million (₹7,175 crore).

The deal, executed through its wholly-owned subsidiary, Inox Solar Americas LLC, also marks the company's first major manufacturing entry into the US and its second overseas acquisition after its Africa foray in February.

TWO-PART DEAL

The transaction is structured in two parts. In the first leg, Inox Clean acquired an operational 3 GW solar module manufacturing facility in the US, built on topcon technology.

In the second leg, it acquired a 3 GW solar cell manufacturing facility that is currently under construction and is expected to be commissioned by December. Together, this gives Inox Clean



EXPANSION DRIVE. Rising electricity demand in the US due to AI, data centres, electrification and industrial growth creates a strong opportunity to scale manufacturing

a 6 GW integrated solar manufacturing base in the US.

ENTRY INTO THE US

Boviet Solar, headquartered in Greenville, North Carolina, is a US-based solar manufacturing platform owned by China's Boway Group. It is among established solar module makers in the US.

The assets also come with existing relationships with global energy customers, giving Inox Clean an immediate entry into the US supply chain. "This will be our first foray into the US market. The acquisition is being done in two parts — an existing 3 GW module facility and a 3

GW cell facility under construction," a company official told *businessline*, adding that the deal will be largely funded through internal accruals.

The acquisition also positions Inox Clean to benefit from US policy support for domestic manufacturing, particularly incentives under Section 45X of the Inflation Reduction Act, which improves project economics for local production.

The US solar manufacturing ecosystem, earlier driven by strong tax incentives and localisation support, is now witnessing a policy recalibration marked by increasing

scrutiny of China-linked ownership, technology and supply-chain exposure. This has created regulatory uncertainty around eligibility for incentives, particularly where Chinese inputs or control are involved, making investors, lenders and insurers more cautious and leading to delays or reassessments of several solar manufacturing projects.

The shift highlights a broader policy tension in the US between scaling clean energy capacity to meet rapidly rising electricity demand and reducing dependence on China-dominated global solar supply chains.

An Inox Clean official said the company had benefited from a "first-mover advantage" amid the evolving US policy environment, which had increased scrutiny on China-linked clean energy assets.

Devansh Jain, Executive Director, INOXGFL Group, said, "Electricity demand is rising sharply due to AI, data centres, electrification and industrial growth, creating a strong opportunity to scale manufacturing in the US."

Will open doors wider, Xi tells US CEOs accompanying Trump

Bloomberg

Xi Jinping signalled China is moving towards greater openness, striking an upbeat note during his meeting with US business leaders accompanying Donald Trump, as the two Presidents wrapped up morning talks that featured more divisive issues, including trade and Taiwan.

"American enterprises are deeply involved in China's reform and opening up, a process from which both sides have benefited," Xi told more than 10 business representatives gathered at the Great Hall of the People in Beijing, China *Central Television* reported. "China's door to the outside world will only open wider."

Footage released by the state broadcaster showed executives, including Tesla Inc's Elon Musk, Apple Inc's Tim Cook, Boeing Co's Kelly Ortberg and Nvidia Corp's Jensen Huang — who joined the trip as a last-minute addition — escorted by staff into the meeting room.

US' FIRST REQUEST

The message sent by Xi reiterated a pledge frequently delivered by senior Chinese



WARM WELCOME. US President Donald Trump inspects a guard of honour in Beijing on Thursday **ANI**

officials on the world stage over the years.

It also appeared to be a response to Trump's appeal to Xi "to open up China," which he'd promised to make as his first request on behalf of the business leaders accompanying him to Beijing.

In his remarks on Thursday, Xi added that he believes US firms will have even broader prospects in China, *CCTV* reported.

'VALUED MARKET'

The American executives told Xi that they "highly value" the Chinese market, and hope to further strengthen cooperation and cultivate their business pres-

ence there, per *CCTV*.

In the afternoon, the CEOs met Chinese Premier Li Qiang, who also struck a positive tone. "Friendly co-operation remains the mainstay of China-US relations," said Li. "China and the US are fully capable of and should continue to be friends and partners, helping each other succeed and achieving shared prosperity."

Trade barriers and market access have been longstanding issues between the world's two biggest economies, especially after China joined the WTO with America's backing more than two decades ago.

Also read p9

Sugar exports banned till Sept 30 to ensure local supply

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

In a move to stabilise the domestic market, the government on Thursday imposed an immediate ban on sugar exports, effective until September 30.

The intervention comes at a critical juncture as global sugar prices show signs of a rebound, which had begun to make Indian exports increasingly attractive to international traders, potentially threatening domestic availability.

EXPORT QUOTA

For the 2025-26 sugar season (October-September), the government had initially authorised an export quota of 1.59 million tonnes (mt). Official data indicated that roughly 0.53 mt had been shipped by the end of March. However, industry intelli-



gence suggests a higher volume of activity, with actual shipments estimated at 0.75 mt and total contracts, including those already shipped, reaching 1 mt. By imposing the ban, the government expects to retain approximately 0.2 mt of sugar that would have otherwise left the country, thereby bolstering local reserves.

A May 13 Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) notification clari-

fied that while the prohibition is immediate, it is scheduled to lapse at the end of September, unless further extensions are deemed necessary.

To maintain international trade obligations and specific refinery operations, the government has provided key exemptions. The ban will not apply to the sweetener exported to the European Union and the US under the CXL and TRQ quotas.

Further, exports under the advance authorisation scheme (AAS), whereby refineries import raw sugar at zero duty to re-export it as refined white sugar, will continue unaffected to support the country's processing industry.

To prevent logistical chaos at ports, the DGFT has outlined transitional arrangements. Shipments will be permitted if the loading of sugar onto vessels com-

menced prior to the May 13 notification. Similarly, consignments will be cleared if a shipping bill was filed and the vessel had already berthed or anchored at an Indian port with an allocated rotation number.

Consignments handed over to Customs and registered in their electronic systems before the cutoff will also be honoured, provided there is verifiable evidence.

SUGAR OUTPUT

This policy shift is rooted in a tightening domestic supply-demand balance. India's net sugar production for the 2025-26 season is estimated at 28 mt.

While this is an improvement over the previous season's 26.1 mt, it matches the country's annual consumption exactly and falls well below the industry's initial expectation of over 30 mt.

BRICS SYNERGY



SHOW OF CAMARADERIE. S Jaishankar, External Affairs Minister (right); Sergey Lavrov, Russian Foreign Minister (middle); Waleed Abdulkarim El Khoreiji, Vice Minister of Foreign Affairs of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia (second from right); Ronald Lamola, South Africa's Minister of Foreign Affairs (left); and Nguyen Hang, Vietnam's Deputy Foreign Minister, on the sidelines of the BRICS Foreign Ministers' Meeting in New Delhi on Thursday. India flagged grave concerns over the West Asia crisis and its impact on energy supplies and maritime stability, and urged BRICS nations to develop ways to navigate geopolitical uncertainties **(Report on Page 8)** **ANI**

Meerut's Sarafa Bazar loses sheen post Modi's call to curb gold purchase

Work has all but come to a halt at colonial-era bullion market; showrooms offer discounts to attract business

Dalip Singh
Meerut

Deserted shops meet one at Meerut's historic Sarafa Bazar, a large colonial-era bullion market famous for its gold, silver and diamond trading, after Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call to curb gold purchase for a year.

A dispirited Meerut Bullion and Jewellers Association has sought an appointment with the PM, its General Secretary Vijayanand Agarwal told *businessline*, saying the industry was desperately seeking relief measures to tide over this latest upheaval. The industry has been facing a slowdown for the last three years, he said.

ANNUAL TURNOVER

The Meerut bullion mar-



DULL DAYS. Traders wonder how they will continue paying staff salaries and provide business to goldsmiths

ket's annual turnover is nearly ₹20,000 crore — a business generated through 200 wholesale stores that work with a network of about 30,000 goldsmiths and other contributors, mostly from West Bengal.

"We would like to offer a suggestion to the Prime Minister to incentivise old jewellery recycling to bring to market idle gold lying in banks," Agarwal said, describing how the dealers

were doing only 20-30 per cent of their regular business now. Offloading gold from the RBI reserve is another idea the association has suggested.

Bullion dealers are in a bind, caught between survival mode and the larger national interest of austerity and "economic patriotism".

At BR Jewelers, which had no customers, owner Ankit Jain wondered how

the traders would sustain staff salaries and provide work to the goldsmiths. "Many of them live on borrowed money and bank loans," said Jain.

"We just come in the morning and go back home in the evening, wondering what is in store for us," said another bullion trader in the bazaar.

He also wondered why no restrictions had been imposed on gold bonds and gold exchange traded fund trading, which allows investors to buy and sell the yellow metal in electronic, digital form on stock exchanges. Gold and silver are *streedhan*, he asserted, and an important part of Indian weddings.

"The gold grey market is already active" was the buzz in Saraf Bazar, where Vijayanand, Ankit and at

least three other traders voiced fears of a rise in precious metal smuggling.

A few showrooms have begun offering a discount of ₹5,000 to ₹7,000 per 10 g to attract some business.

The volatile gold prices in India are at ₹16,158 per g for 24 carats and ₹14,806 per g for 22 carats.

Nazrul, a goldsmith who works out of a tiny room on the third floor of a dilapidated building tucked inside the narrow Neel Gali in Agarwal Market, said that the stores are cutting down on workers, and business has been reduced to working on just 100 g of gold per day — a steep slide from the at least 500 g they would work on even in slowdown days.

"Now, we barely manage to get ₹500-700 per day for our sweat," he said.

TaMo profit slips 32% as JLR weakness overshadows record Q4 for India arm

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Tata Motors reported a weaker-than-expected March quarter as a sharp slowdown at Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) overshadowed a record performance from its India passenger vehicle business, highlighting the group's continued dependence on its global luxury unit for profits.

The consolidated revenue rose 7.2 per cent to ₹1,05,447 crore in Q4 from ₹98,355 crore a year earlier, while the net profit attributable to shareholders fell 31.7 per cent to ₹5,783 crore from ₹8,470 crore. The results missed Street estimates for both revenue and profit.

The shortfall was driven by JLR, where revenue declined 11.1 per cent to ₹6.9 billion and wholesale volumes fell 14.5 per cent to 95,300 units in Q4. "We con-

tinue to build vehicles and work closely with our suppliers and logistics partners to navigate the shipping disruptions," said JLR CFO Richard Molyneux during the post-results media call, referring to tensions in West Asia.

West Asia accounts for about 6 per cent of JLR's global sales, and the company has paused all travel to and through the region.

JLR REVENUE

For FY26, JLR revenue fell 20.9 per cent to £22.9 billion, while the EBIT margin dropped to 0.7 per cent from 8.5 per cent. Profit before tax and before exceptional items collapsed to £14 million from £2.5 billion. Molyneux said JLR is targeting annual break-even volumes of around 3,00,000 units over the next two years through £1.7 billion of cost savings and new launches, including Range Rover Electric.

In contrast, Tata Motors'

India passenger vehicle business delivered its strongest-ever quarter. Volumes rose 37 per cent to 2,01,800 units, revenue jumped 49.4 per cent to ₹18,742 crore, and EBIT margin improved to 4.7 per cent from 1.6 per cent.

Shailesh Chandra, MD of Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles and Tata Passenger Electric Mobility, in the post results call, said demand remained strong in April and May and the passenger vehicle industry could grow about 10 per cent in FY27.

Tata expects industry-beating growth, supported by launches, including the Sierrra and Harrier EV.

Even after its best-ever quarter, Tata's domestic passenger vehicle business remains less than half as profitable as JLR on an operating margin basis, showing that the group's earnings are still tied to the recovery of its global luxury business.

Also read p2

QUICKLY.

Tesla opens experience centre in Bengaluru



Bengaluru: Tesla has opened its fourth experience centre in Bengaluru's Whitefield. Since entering India in July 2025, Tesla has opened experience centres in Mumbai, Delhi, and Gurugram, with Bengaluru emerging as its fourth key market. It has sold over 340 vehicles in India so far, largely driven by the Model Y lineup, while also expanding charging and service infrastructure across major metros. **OUR BUREAU**

Freshworks expands IT service management biz

Chennai: Freshworks on Thursday announced an expansion of the agentic capabilities of its IT service management business. The expansion is anchored around a new no-code Freddy AI Agent Studio that allows firms to create AI Agents or extend capabilities of domain-specific AI Agents. **OUR BUREAU**

Cars, 2-, 3Ws swerve past price hikes in Apr, touch record sales

MARUTI WINS. Mahindra, TaMo, JSW MG, Kia announced hikes of up to 3% from April 1

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Led by continued demand momentum after the GST rate cut last year and new launches, cars, two-wheelers and three-wheelers recorded double-digit wholesales (dispatches to dealers) growth in the domestic market in April, even though several automakers began the month with a price hike due to higher input costs.

In the passenger vehicles (PVs) segment, except Maruti Suzuki India (MSIL), companies like Mahindra & Mahindra, Tata Motors, JSW MG Motor, and Kia India, etc. had announced price hikes of up to 3 per cent from April 1.

According to the monthly sales data shared by the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM) on Thursday, the PVs recorded their highest-ever sales of 4,37,312 units in April with a growth of 25.4 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y), over

In full throttle			
Segment/ Sub-segment	April 2025	April 2026	y-o-y % change
Total PVs	3,48,847	4,37,312	25.4
Total three-wheelers	49,441	65,668	32.8
Scooter	5,48,370	6,91,993	26.2
Motorcycle	8,71,666	11,38,452	30.6
Total two-wheelers	14,58,784	18,72,691	28.4
Grand total of all categories	18,57,072	23,75,671	27.9

3,48,847 units in April 2025.

“The first month of FY27, posted high double-digit growth in PVs, three-wheelers and two-wheelers. In April 2026, PVs recorded their highest-ever sales of 4.37 lakh units with a growth of 25.4 per cent over April 2025. Though there are concerns of high commodity prices emanating from the disruptions in West Asia, industry has been witnessing good demand,” said Rajesh Menon, Director General, SIAM.

MARUTI'S RECORD

Market leader MSIL recorded its all-time high monthly sales since its inception to 1,87,704 units in April

against 1,38,704 units in April 2025, up 35.3 per cent. Its small car segment had also grown by 74.4 per cent y-o-y during the month.

Similarly, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles recorded domestic wholesales of 59,000 units in April, up 30.5 per cent y-o-y against 45,199 units in April last year.

M&M also reported 8 per cent increase in its domestic wholesales to 56,331 units, against 52,330 units in the same month last year.

Hyundai Motor India (HMIL) also said it achieved the highest-ever monthly sales for any April with domestic wholesales of 51,902 units last month, a y-o-y growth of 17 per cent as com-

pared with 44,374 units in April 2025.

RUNNING ON TWO

Likewise, in the two-wheeler segment, the total wholesales grew by 28.4 per cent y-o-y to 18,72,691 units during the month against 14,58,784 units in the year-ago period, as per the latest data shared by SIAM.

Motorcycle sales grew by 30.6 per cent y-o-y to 11,38,452 units (against 8,71,666 units in April 2025), and scooter sales grew by 26.2 per cent y-o-y to 6,91,993 units (5,48,370 units). In the three-wheeler segment, domestic sales grew by 32.8 per cent y-o-y to 65,668 units in April against 49,441 units in April 2025.

Cumulatively, all categories grew by 28 per cent y-o-y to 23,75,671 units during the month against 18,57,072 units in April 2025.

In terms of exports, the grand total of all categories grew by 38 per cent y-o-y to 6,28,128 units in April (4,55,330 units).

Tata Motors PV staff could gain ₹168 crore under new stock scheme

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Ltd has approved a stock-linked incentive scheme that could generate about ₹168 crore in pre-tax gains for employees, enabling eligible staff to acquire shares worth roughly ₹169 crore for just ₹1 crore, subject to vesting and performance conditions.

“The Board of Directors has considered and approved the adoption of ‘Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles Limited Share-based Long Term Incentive Scheme 2026’ involving not exceeding 50,00,000 equity shares of the company,” it said in a regulatory filing on Wednesday.

Under the scheme, up to 50 lakh performance share units (PSUs) will be granted to eligible employees. Each PSU carries the right to one equity share and can be exercised at ₹2 per share, the face value of the stock.

Based on Tata Motors’ closing share price of ₹338

on Wednesday, the 50 lakh shares covered under the plan would be worth about ₹169 crore. Employees would collectively pay ₹1 crore to exercise the awards (50 lakh shares multiplied by ₹2 each), implying a potential gain of roughly ₹168 crore before taxes.

The company said the scheme would result in a maximum dilution of approximately 0.14 per cent of its issued share capital.

RETAINING MEASURE

Industry observers said the timing reflects how automakers are increasingly using equity compensation to retain engineers, software developers and product leaders as vehicles become more

technology-intensive and competition for specialised talent rises.

“Automotive companies are now competing for coders, battery specialists and vehicle architects in the same way technology firms compete for engineers,” said an executive compensation adviser to listed companies. “A performance-linked stock plan gives employees a direct stake in the company's future and can create significant wealth if execution remains strong.”

The filing does not disclose how the awards will be allocated among employees. In similar programmes, grants are typically based on role, performance, strategic importance and retention priorities rather than tenure alone.

Because the awards are structured as performance share units, employees will receive shares only after meeting specified performance and service conditions. Vested units must be exercised within 12 months from the date of vesting.

Sunil Mittal plans to pass on the baton, regain 50% in Airtel

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Sunil Bharti Mittal, Chairman, Airtel, on Thursday said that he plans to hand over the reins of the telecom giant to the next generation in the next decade or so, and desires for promoter firm Bharti Telecom to regain over 50 per cent stake in the company.

Owned by his family and Singtel Group, Bharti Telecom at present holds 40.47 per cent stake in Airtel. The promoter firms, including

Bharti Telecom, the Mittal family-holding firm Indian Continent Investment (ICIL), the Singtel Group firm Pastel, and others jointly hold a 48.87 per cent stake in Airtel.

“My wish is that in the next next decade I hand over the reins to the next generation and shareholders, Bharti Telecom should get back to controlling shareholding 51 per cent or just over 50 per cent. And, for a company of this magnitude and size, you can imagine that is not a small task,” Mittal responded to a question in a post

earnings call with analysts.

The 68-year-old telecom czar has been reappointed Chairman for five years till September 30, 2031. His current term was due to expire on September 30.

“Direction or vision that I carry is [that] all [the] share from both the ICIL or Bharti family entities and Singtel should go into Bharti Telecom as much as possible. Singtel had a difference of about 7 per cent or rather has 7 per cent direct take in Airtel and it had about 6 per cent to equalise. Once this transaction is done and share is-

sued, this gap comes down to 3.6 per cent,” Mittal said.

AIRTEL AFRICA

Mittal added that acquiring more stakes in Airtel Africa is a win-win situation for the shareholders and going forward, the target is to acquire 90 per cent stake there.

The Board of Airtel on Wednesday approved raising the company's stake in Airtel Africa by 16.31 per cent to around 79 per cent through a share swap agreement worth ₹28,220 crore, from the current 62.73 per cent.

“The Africa transaction,

announced yesterday, is akin to acquiring another large company. This takes us to approximately 78 per cent ownership in Airtel Africa. Our ambition should eventually be to move closer to the 90 per cent threshold permitted under UK regulations,” he said.

“That would allow more income to flow to Bharti Airtel shareholders. Between India and Africa, reaching 800 million customers across mobile, broadband, digital services and financial services is a visible dream,” he added.

Record turnover, JV drive JSW Steel Q4 profits

Our Bureau
Mumbai

JSW Steel on Thursday reported a sharp rise in its fourth-quarter (Q4) earnings, aided by record steel sales, higher realisations and an exceptional gain from the slump sale of the BPSL steel undertaking. Normalised net profit, excluding the exceptional item was at ₹3,475 crore.

Revenue from operations rose 14 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to a record ₹51,180 crore. Adjusted EBITDA for

Resilient growth (₹ crore)		
	Q4FY25	Q4FY26
Revenues from operations	44,819	51,180
Net profit	1,503	16,370*
Exceptional items	-	17,888

*normalised profit excluding exceptional items - ₹3,475 cr

the quarter increased 50 per cent y-o-y to ₹9,713 crore, while EBITDA margin improved to 19 per cent from 14.5 per cent a year earlier. EBITDA per tonne rose 42 per cent to ₹12,264 in the quarter.

CAPEX PIPELINE

The company, which has a target to reach 50 million tons by FY31, sees the total group capacity rising to 80 million tonnes, including its joint ventures with JFE and POSCO and operations in Ohio. The BPSL acquisition had transformed its balance sheet, said Joint Managing Director and CEO, Jayant

Acharya, adding that leveraging of ₹37,000 crore was underway, of which nearly ₹30,000 crore was completed. The expansion projects at Vijayanagar and Odisha were progressing on schedule, while downstream projects in coated steel, tinplate and speciality steel were also underway, he said.

While the current capex guidance of ₹1.26 lakh crore over 4-5 years was on track, he said the company would be stepping up its annual capex run rate to ₹30,000-35,000 crore from ₹20,000 crore now.

He added that the incremental EBITDA from new

projects at ₹9000-12,000 crore would support capex.

RECORD STEEL SALES

Steel sales hit an all-time high of 7.97 million tonnes (mt), up 6 per cent y-o-y, while domestic sales also touched a record 7.09 million tonnes. Exports rose 36 per cent y-o-y and accounted for 10 per cent of Indian operations sales. Crude steel production stood at 7.49 mt.

For FY26, the company posted revenue of ₹1.85 lakh crore and reported EBITDA of ₹29,821 crore. Annual crude steel production stood at 30.14 million tonnes while sales rose 12 per cent to 29.63 million tonnes.

The company said net debt fell sharply to ₹53,870 crore at the end of March 2026 from ₹80,347 crore in December 2025, aided by leveraging following the BPSL transaction and healthy cash generation.

Tube Investments to scale up EV, medical biz

Our Bureau
Chennai



Tube Investments of India (TII) is looking to scale-up its electric vehicle (EV) and medical businesses while planning a capital expenditure of ₹300-350 crore in its core operations and another ₹300 crore investment in its subsidiaries during FY27, said Managing Director Mukesh Ahuja.

The company said it is witnessing strong demand for its electric commercial vehicles, particularly in the heavy truck and small commercial vehicle segments, though deployment is constrained by financing and charging infrastructure bottlenecks, he told analysts while discussing the company's Q4 financial results.

For FY27, TII expects capex of ₹300-350 crore in its standalone businesses,

on a very good order book for big trucks,” during the company's post-results investor call.

However, deployment challenges stem mainly from financing requirements and the need to establish charging infrastructure along routes, he added.

Advances in higher-capacity batteries and fast-charging technology are shifting industry preference away from battery swapping for long-haul electric trucks, although swapping could continue in applications such as ports, he said.

TI Clean Mobility retained leadership in the electric truck segment with about 28 per cent market share despite rising competition, said Gupta.

3W BUSINESS

On the three-wheeler business, he said production was hit in the March quarter after

it took over a body-in-white supplier facility to resolve supply bottlenecks. The issue has now largely been addressed, and production is expected to normalise by June-end.

The company also outlined expansion plans in medical devices. Tube Investments recently completed the acquisition of assets of an IV cannula facility at Ambala and expects commercial production to begin in the second quarter after regulatory approvals. The management said it remains confident of delivering 15-20 per cent annual growth in the medical business.

On the contract development and manufacturing organisation (CDMO) business, the company said the Naidupeta facility is in the final stages of commissioning, and commercial production is expected to begin next quarter.

United Spirits Q4 PAT rises to ₹568 cr

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

United Spirits Ltd reported a net sales value (NSV) of ₹3,054 crore in Q4FY26, up 3.7 per cent increase from the year-ago period. The company posted a profit after tax (PAT) of ₹568 crore for the quarter.

For the full fiscal year, the company's NSV stood at ₹12,467 crore, or a 7.7 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) growth, while PAT came in at ₹1,709 crore, up from ₹1,582 crore in FY25.

On a standalone basis, the Prestige & Above (P&A) seg-

ment grew 5 per cent during Q4, which also witnessed the adverse impact of Maharashtra-made liquor (MML) on both the popular and lower prestige segments in the State.

Excluding Maharashtra and Andhra Pradesh, at a national level, the overall portfolio as well as P&A segment delivered a growth of 8.5 per cent in Q4.

However, NSV for the popular segment declined 13.2 per cent, mainly due to MML impact in the salient State.

GOING PREMIUM

Praveen Someshwar, CEO & Managing Director, commenting on the FY26 performance, said, “We welcome the progressive policy

in the State of Karnataka, which has the potential to provide a fillip to the premiumisation journey in the State. This, along with UK-FTA on the anvil, bodes well for our business and gives us confidence to deliver on our medium-term guidance of double-digit growth.”

He noted that during the quarter, the Board of Directors approved the sale of “our 100 per cent stake in Royal Challengers Sports Private Limited (RCSPL)” in March. “This transaction further enables us to sharpen our focus on the core beverage alcohol business,” he shared.

Total volumes for the quarter were 15.7 million cases, compared with 16.6 million cases in the corresponding period last year.

Pricol consolidated profit doubles to ₹73 cr in Q4

Our Bureau
Chennai

Pricol Ltd, the Coimbatore-based automotive component manufacturer, doubled its consolidated net profit to ₹73 crore in the fourth quarter ended March 31, 2026 compared with ₹35 crore in the corresponding quarter last year.

Revenue was up by 43 per cent to ₹1,078 crore (₹752 crore).

For FY26, the consolidated net profit rose by 43 per cent to ₹251 crore (₹167 crore) on a 51 per cent revenue in profit to ₹3,964 crore (₹2,621 crore).

On a standalone basis, the net profit more than doubled to ₹78 crore (₹28 crore) on 38 per cent increase in revenue to ₹834 crore (₹606 crore).

For FY26, net profit rose by 46 per cent to ₹207 crore

(₹142 crore) on a 22 per cent increase in revenue to ₹3,019 crore (₹2,458 crore).

BOARD LEADERSHIP

Pricol announced a leadership transition during the quarter, with Vikram Mohan succeeding Vanitha Mohan as Chairman, stated a company release.

Vikram Mohan said: “FY26 was a defining year for the global automotive industry, marked by supply chain disruptions, geopolitical trade tensions and continued market volatility.”

Despite these challenges, Pricol demonstrated strong resilience, agility and execution excellence.

This enabled us to outperform the market and achieve the milestone of ₹4,000 crore in total income through a balanced mix of organic and inorganic growth, as outlined in our strategic commitment for FY26.

Sundaram Clayton profit doubles to ₹426 cr

Our Bureau
Chennai

Sundaram Clayton Ltd, the Chennai-based automotive component manufacturer, more than doubled its consolidated net profit for the fourth quarter ended March 31, 2026, to ₹426 crore compared to ₹144 crore in the corresponding quarter last year, mainly driven by profit on the sale of assets amounting to ₹521 crore during the quarter.

Revenue declined by 12 per cent to ₹518 crore (₹587 crore).

For FY26, the consolidated net profit was ₹252 crore on a loss of ₹11 crore in the previous fiscal. Revenue declined by 10 per cent to ₹2,026 crore (₹2,260 crore).

On a standalone basis, the company more than doubled its net profit to ₹494 crore in Q4 FY26 against ₹209 crore in the corresponding quarter last year.

Revenue declined by 18

One of the strongest quarters (₹ crore)

	Q4'25	Q4'26	FY25	FY26
PAT	144	426	-11	252
Revenue	587	518	2,260	2,026
Exceptional item	-8	521	197	513

per cent to ₹444 crore (₹524 crore).

For FY26, the standalone net profit doubled to ₹552 crore (₹258 crore) on a 15 per cent decline in revenue to ₹1,788 crore (₹2,109 crore).

The company's board, in March, declared an interim dividend of ₹4.5 per share, absorbing a sum of ₹9.92 crore for the fiscal 2025-26.

The fourth quarter marked one of the strongest quarters for the Indian auto industry in recent years, supported by favourable macroeconomic conditions and policy-led demand recovery, stated a release.

On exports, the company said that the North American truck market continued to witness muted demand dur-

ing Q4 FY26, primarily due to cautious fleet capital expenditure decisions, geopolitical and macroeconomic uncertainties.

Consequently, export demand remained relatively subdued during the quarter, particularly in the heavy truck segment, despite long-term growth outlook in the North American market, the release said.

INDIA OPERATIONS

The West Asia region continues to pose challenges in navigating raw material availability, supply chain continuity and profitability. Increase in aluminium prices, energy costs, freight rates and foreign exchange movements may potentially impact margins.

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DGFT tightens norms for import of gold inputs by jewellers for exports

NEW RESTRICTIONS. Cap of 100 kg imposed; mandatory physical inspection of manufacturing facilities for first-timers

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

A day after the Finance Ministry increased import duty on gold to 15 per cent from 6 per cent to discourage inflows, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) has tightened the regulatory framework for duty-free gold imports used by the gems and jewellery sector as inputs for exports. It introduced five new restrictive notes under the Standard Input Output Norms (SION).

“Five notes are inserted under SIONs... prescribing conditions for the issuance and monitoring of Advance Authorisations for import of



IMPORT CURB. The increase in import duty for gold is aimed at discouraging imports to curb a widening trade deficit

gold,” per the DGFT public notice issued on Thursday.

AA SCHEME
The Advance Authorisation (AA) scheme for the gems and jewellery sector allows

exporters to import gold duty-free, provided it is used specifically to manufacture jewellery for export. The SIONs define how much gold is required to produce a specific amount of jewellery.

Under the revised guidelines, a strict ceiling has been placed, with gold import authorisations capped at a maximum of 100 kilograms.

The DGFT has mandated a physical inspection of manufacturing facilities for all first-time applicants to verify their operational status and capacity. The issuance of subsequent licences will now be considered only when exporters fulfill at least 50 per cent of the export obligations from their preceding authorizations before new ones are granted, the notice added.

Authorisation holders will have to submit fortnightly performance reports certified by an independent

Chartered Accountant to improve compliance.

MONTHLY REPORT
Regional authorities concerned shall submit a monthly consolidated report to DGFT headquarters containing details regarding the issuance of Advance Authorisations and corresponding import/export transactions of gold to enable centralised monitoring and policy oversight, it added.

The increase in import duty for gold is aimed at discouraging its imports to curb a widening trade deficit and stabilise the rupee amid the West Asia crisis. The government is moving to preserve forex for essential energy and defence needs.

Govt confirms safe passage of two LPG tankers through Strait of Hormuz

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government on Thursday said that two liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) tankers are en route to India after crossing the Strait of Hormuz. However, one Sharjah-bound Indian-flagged vessel sank after being hit near the strategic shipping corridor.

Addressing an inter-ministerial briefing, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Ports, Shipping & Waterways, Mukesh Mangal said that LPG tanker *Symy* transited through the Strait on May 13, while *NV Sunshine* safely crossed the waterway on Thursday. This brings the total number of Indian vessels to have crossed the shipping channel, which had been effectively shut since the US-Israel strikes on Iran and Tehran’s retaliation more than two months ago, to 13.

Mangal said *Symy*, a Marshall Islands-flagged vessel carrying 19,965 tonnes of LPG, is expected to arrive at Kandla in Gujarat on May 16. *NV Sunshine*, a Vietnam-flagged vessel carrying 46,427 tonnes of LPG cargo, is expected to arrive at New



Mukesh Mangal, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Ports in Shipping & Waterways

Mangalore on May 18, he said, adding that the cargo on both vessels belongs to Indian Oil Corporation (IOC).

12 VESSELS STRANDED
Since early March, 13 India-flagged vessels, including 12 LPG tankers and one crude oil tanker, have crossed the Strait of Hormuz, even as tensions in the region continue to disrupt maritime traffic. Several foreign-flagged energy tankers carrying cargo for India have also arrived from the Persian Gulf after transiting the strategic waterway. At least 12 Indian vessels remain stranded in the Gulf, along with multiple foreign ships transporting India-bound cargo.

The passage of two India-bound LPG vessels occurred amid a deadlock in negotiations to end the war and the arrival of Iranian Foreign

Minister Abbas Araghchi in New Delhi to attend the BRICS Foreign Ministers’ meeting.

Meanwhile, *Haji Ali*, an Indian dhow or mechanised sailing vessel (MSV), came under attack in the early hours of Wednesday in Omani waters during its voyage from Somalia to Sharjah, UAE, leading to a fire onboard the wooden vessel and its subsequent sinking.

“All 14 crew members onboard (*Haji Ali*) were safely rescued by the Omani Coast Guard and have reached Dibba Port in Oman. The crew is reported to be safe, and necessary formalities with the local authorities have been completed,” Mangal said while asserting that the crew will be brought back to India soon.

“The government remains in close coordination with the authorities in the Sultanate of Oman, Indian Mission officials and relevant maritime agencies,” he said. The vessel was 57 metres long and 14 metres wide. An Indian dhow is a traditional, usually wooden, sailing vessel with one or more masts and characteristic lateen (triangular) sails, essential to maritime trade in the Indian Ocean for centuries.

Govt assesses infra needs to help exporters benefit from free trade pacts

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

In a bid to expand the capacity of industry to benefit from free trade agreements (FTAs), the government has initiated a comprehensive assessment of infrastructure requirements in industrial clusters, including testing facilities and international certification processes.

The Department of Commerce aims to bridge the gap between India’s expanding network of FTAs and the currently low utilisation of the pacts that have already been implemented, is by providing adequate infrastructure to exporters to meet standards and timelines, a person tracking the development said.

Despite successfully finalising or signing landmark deals with major partners, including Australia, the UAE, Mauritius, the UK, New Zealand, Oman, and the EU, a big concern on their future utilisation remains as Indian exporters have struggled to fully capitalise on preferential market access gained in past FTAs.

Earlier FTAs, such as ones

with the Asean, Japan and South Korea, or recent ones such as with the UAE, have been sub-optimally used by exporters. Government estimates suggest not just utilisation but utilisation rate of many of these FTAs, too, remains persistently low.

DATA SOUGHT
“In a direct outreach to industry clusters, the Ministry is now seeking data on specific infrastructure bottlenecks that prevent goods from moving seamlessly from Indian factory floors to international markets,” the source said.

Through communications to various export promotion councils, the Department of Commerce has requested members to identify critical needs in areas such as specialised testing laboratories, international certification centres, logistics hubs, and meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions (MICE) facilities.

“Industry members have been asked to provide not only a list of required facilities but also the estimated expenditure involved in creating such infrastructure,” the source noted.

WPI inflation hits 42-month high of 8.3% in April as fuel prices surge

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With the rise in fuel prices, wholesale inflation, based on the Wholesale Price Index (WPI), surged to a 42-month high of 8.3 per cent in April, the government reported on Thursday. The rate stood at 3.88 per cent in March.

“The positive rate of inflation in April is primarily due to the increase in prices of mineral oils, crude petroleum & natural gas, basic metals, other manufactured products, and non-food articles, etc.,” a statement from the Ministry of Commerce and Industry said.

According to the data, WPI-based inflation in the fuel and power segment jumped to 24.71 per cent in April from 1.05 per cent in March. In crude petroleum, inflation hit 88.06 per cent in April, compared to 51.5 per cent in the previous month. The sharp rise in WPI inflation reflects the impact of the West Asia crisis and the effective blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, through which the majority of India’s crude oil is imported.

Wholesale inflation					
(All figures in %)					
Head	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26 Apr-26
All commodities	-0.13	0.96	1.68	2.26	3.88 8.30
Primary articles	-2.53	0.21	2.27	3.21	6.36 9.17
Fuel & power	-2.33	-2.31	-4.01	-3.85	1.05 24.71
Manufactured products	1.47	2.03	2.58	3.13	3.39 4.62

Source: Commerce & Industry Ministry

was 25.19 per cent in April, against 3.26 per cent in March.

Despite a 50 per cent spike in global crude oil prices, the government has so far kept fuel pump and household LPG rates stable to shield households from the impact of rising retail prices for petrol, diesel, and LPG. However, prices for commercial LPG cylinders have been increased.

Inflation in food articles was 1.98 per cent in April, compared to 1.90 per cent in March. In non-food articles, inflation rose to 12.18 per cent in April from 11.5 per cent in the previous month, according to data released by the Ministry of Commerce and Industry.

Commenting on the numbers, Rahul Agrawal, Senior Economist at ICRA, said the sizeable jump in WPI inflation across some segments between March 2026 and April 2026 suggests that the former may be revised upwards when the final numbers for the month are released in June.

Looking ahead, food prices have hardened in early May

relative to April levels, in line with normal seasonal trends, which is likely to further push up the y-o-y WPI-food inflation print in the current month.

This, along with the continued pass-through of elevated energy and commodity prices and the depreciation of the rupee against the dollar is expected to push the WPI print for May above 9 per cent.

HIGHER ENERGY PRICES
With the sharp increase in WPI inflation in April 2026, the wedge between the CPI and WPI prints widened to a 44-month high of 482 bps, up from a relatively mild 47 bps in March 2026, amid a faster transmission of rising energy and commodity prices into the former category *vis-à-vis* the latter.

“This reinforces our expectation that CPI inflation would cross 4 per cent in May. Nevertheless, the MPC may remain on hold in the June policy review given the lack of visibility regarding the duration of the West Asia conflict and the transience of the current price shock,” said Agrawal.

WFH, online meetings, curbs on vehicle use among Delhi govt’s measures to save fuel

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

In line with Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s appeal for fuel conservation, the Delhi government has announced a set of measures aimed at reducing fuel consumption.

On Thursday, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said that the government had introduced a structured plan to promote fuel efficiency as well as responsible resource use across departments.

As part of this policy, all Delhi government employees will work from home for two days every week.

Besides, 50 per cent of official meetings will now be conducted online to reduce travel-related fuel consumption. The

Delhi government and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi will revise office timings to help decongest peak-hour traffic and improve fuel efficiency across the Capital. Further, the State government plans to reduce petrol allocation for officers by 20 per cent, bringing the monthly cap down from 200 litres.

Meanwhile, the use of official vehicles will be restricted as part of broader expenditure rationalisation measures. Additionally, the State government has decided not to procure any new vehicle for the next six months.

On the mobility front, the government will introduce a designated “Metro Day”, on which ministers and senior officials will use Metro services for official commutes.

Apart from this, the citizens will be encouraged to observe a weekly “No Car Day” to further reduce fuel usage and road congestion.

To support employee commuting requirements, 58 special buses will be operated across 29 government residential colonies for staff transportation.

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India Inc raises 33% less via ECBs in FY26 as bank credit turns attractive

K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

India Inc’s funding via the external commercial borrowing (ECB) route at about \$41 billion in FY26 was 33 per cent lower compared to \$61 billion in FY25 as companies stepped up borrowing from domestic banks amid softer interest rates and a depreciating currency.

In fact, in FY26, March saw the highest borrowing of \$5.43 billion by Indian companies via ECB. However, this was much lower than the March 2025 ECB mop up of a whopping \$11.04 billion, per RBI data. The moderation in ECB reflects both favourable domestic interest rates following monetary policy easing and higher hedging costs making ECB loans costly, according to the central bank.

ECBs are commercial loans raised by eligible resident entities from recognised non-resident entities. In current easing cycle (February 2025 to February 2026), the RBI’s monetary policy committee cumulatively cut the repo rate by 125 basis points (bps) from 6.50 per cent to 5.25 per cent, the weighted average lending rate (WALR) of scheduled commercial banks on fresh and outstanding rupee loans declined by 89 bps and 87 bps respectively.

WEAKENING RUPEE
The rupee weakened about 10 per cent in FY26, depreciating more than the average in the previous years. Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, said: “We have seen that bank credit growth was very good at about 16 per cent. So, the choice is really between domestic borrowing and overseas borrowing.”

According to bankers’ borrowing from Indian banks was at least 100 basis points cheaper for Indian companies as compared to ECBs in FY27.

In the reporting month, the companies that raised \$100 million plus funds via ECBs include Rajasthan Part I Transmission Ltd (\$750 million), IIFL Finance (\$700 million), Adani Transmission Step-One (\$500 million), Bajaj Finance and Sammaan Capital (\$400 million each), Indian Railway Finance Corp (\$391.58 million), REC (\$250 million), Interglobe Aviation (\$212 million) Aditya Birla Capital (\$200 million), Nuclear Power Corporation of India (\$198.51 million), and National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (\$125 million).



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PARTICULARS	STANDALONE			CONSOLIDATED		
	FY 2026	FY 2025	% Increase	FY 2026	FY 2025	% Increase
Loan Assets (₹)	1,62,826	1,08,648	50%	1,81,916	1,22,181	49%
Total Revenue (₹)	27,600	17,135	61%	31,263	20,265	54%
Profit After Tax (₹)	10,134	5,201	95%	10,607	5,352	98%
Net Worth (₹)	37,742	28,438	33%	39,130	29,367	33%
Earnings Per Share (₹10/- each) (Basic) (₹)	252.43	129.54	95%	263.79	132.84	99%
Book Value Per Share (₹)	940.05	708.26	33%	974.57	731.35	33%
Dividend Per Share (₹)	30.00	26.00	15%	-	-	-

EXTRACT OF AUDITED STANDALONE & CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE YEAR ENDED 31st MARCH, 2026

Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Audited Financial Results and is not a statutory advertisement required under SEBI guidelines. The detailed financials and investor presentation is available on the website of the Company at www.muthootfinance.com

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Precious saving

Increasing import duties on gold, the right step

The Centre’s move to increase import duty on gold and silver from 6 per cent to 15 per cent and the duty on platinum imports from 6.4 per cent to 15.4 per cent was expected. Gold and silver imports ballooned in FY26, preceding the impact of the Iran war which broke out late February, putting the current account balance under stress. Since the war, the rupee has lost almost 5 per cent.



With gold prices having risen about 30 per cent over a year and holding firm now at \$4,700/troy ounce, India is staring at the prospect of another year of high foreign exchange outgo on imports if it does not change its ways. At \$83 billion in FY26, gold and silver already exceed 10 per cent of the total import bill. A drop in import volumes will be necessary to offset the double whammy of firm prices and a weak currency. The Prime Minister’s appeal to households to postpone gold purchases should be seen in this light. Gold is largely viewed as a non-essential import with industrial demand limited to 13 per cent of its consumption. So, clamping down on consumption will not impact economic activity. To be sure, the volume of gold imports came down from 879 tonnes in FY22 to 721 tonnes in FY26, but the increase in gold prices resulted in a spike in value terms. Gold imports stood at \$72 billion in FY26, up 24 per cent over FY25, while silver imports at \$12 billion were 150 per cent higher than in the previous fiscal. The sharp increase in gold prices since 2024 appears to have stoked investment demand too, with demand for gold exchange traded funds as well as gold bars and coins witnessing an increase.

Duty increases can dampen both types of gold demand — namely, retail and investment. The Centre has done well to close an arbitrage possibility between FTA and general rates, by increasing the concessional duty on gold imported from the UAE (under the India-UAE Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement) from 5 per cent to 14 per cent. In the past, gold imports declined substantially in value terms in the months following Centre’s import duty hikes. This was observed in 2013, 2019 and 2022. If that scenario plays out now, the import bill can be expected to decline \$6-9 billion following the nine percentage points increase in the levy. Given the unrelenting pressure on the balance of payments due to continuing foreign portfolio outflows, increasing oil import bill, decline in inward remittances and impact of the war on exports, the Centre will have to use all tools at its disposal.

There is a downside to these duty hikes — the prospect of gold being smuggled into the country, as the price gap between domestic market and overseas market widens. The Centre will have to heighten its vigilance. The Centre may also want to consider another, better designed and implemented scheme of gold monetisation as a way to step up recycling of idle domestic gold.

OTHER VOICES.

The Moscow Times

As the world watches Iran, Ukraine seizing the initiative
Since the start of the war in Iran, conventional wisdom says that Russia has enjoyed a windfall from soaring oil prices so great that it has strengthened its position in the war in Ukraine. This has even trickled into the White House, which is quietly continuing to incentivise Russia to end the war, while Moscow claims that Kyiv is “militarily defeated.” But that consensus has masked a far more overlooked truth. Rather than Russia, it is Ukraine that has recently seen its most successful stretch, both on and off the battlefield, in years — and perhaps since the war first began. Start with the battlefield first. Not only has Ukraine managed to stave off Russia’s years-long offensive, forcing Moscow’s troops to advance at a slog so slow they are reminiscent of World War I. But in recent weeks, Kyiv has managed to capture more territory than the Kremlin for the first time in nearly three years.

GULF NEWS

Gulf universities: Global partnerships to local strength
As schools and universities in the UAE reopen, the moment offers a useful reminder. The real test of a higher education system is not only the calibre of the institutions linked to it, but its ability to sustain learning, support students, and adapt when conditions become less predictable. That is a timely point for the Gulf. Across the UAE, Saudi Arabia, and Qatar, governments have spent years investing in higher education to raise quality, widen access, and strengthen their position in the global knowledge economy. International partnerships have been central to that effort. Branch campuses, research collaborations and faculty exchanges have broadened academic choice, introduced global standards, and accelerated transfer of expertise.



A NARAYANAMOORTHY

The Tamil Nadu Assembly election of 2026 has imprinted a permanent mark on India’s political history. Actor Vijay’s Tamilaga Vетtri Kazhagam (TVK) has achieved what many deemed impossible: storming into power and dismantling some six decades of bipolar Dravidian rule. However, as the initial dust of celebration settles, the new administration finds itself at a critical crossroads. While winning the election was a cinematic feat, the new government now faces harsh economic realities that require sound policy rather than just public appeal.

The most immediate challenge facing the TVK government is the State’s fiscal health. Tamil Nadu currently has the largest absolute debt among all States. The outstanding debt is projected to reach approximately ₹10.71 lakh crore for the 2026-27 fiscal year. This has an intuitive impact on the State’s spending capacity. The total annual debt servicing cost (interest plus principal repayment) alone is expected to touch a staggering ₹1.16 lakh crore at the end of March 2026. This debt trap effectively crowds out capital expenditure. If a significant portion of every rupee earned goes towards paying off past borrowings, the government’s ability to build new schools, hospitals and infrastructure is severely restricted.

Furthermore, both the electricity sector (burdened by a debt exceeding ₹1.5 lakh crore as of March 2026) and the transport sector are grappling with a severe financial crisis. Adding to this pressure is the party’s own electoral promises. The TVK manifesto includes substantial welfare commitments, such as the ₹2,500 monthly assistance for women heads of households, provision of six free LPG cylinders annually, monthly allowance for unemployed, etc. While these freebies are aimed at social upliftment, they represent a massive recurring expenditure that will further strain the State’s already fragile fiscal condition.

THE GROWTH-REVENUE PARADOX
While the State’s Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) is resilient and projected to grow by nearly 15 per cent at current prices in 2025-26, there is a worrying disconnect between economic expansion and State income. Tax receipts have not increased in consonance with GSDP growth in recent years.

This paradox stems from several factors. First, the transition to the GST regime has limited the State’s flexibility in revenue generation, with the tax-to-GSDP ratio witnessing a gradual decline in recent years, from 6.40 per

TVK will need to deal with economic challenges

LEGACY ISSUES. The new govt in TN has inherited a mountain of debt, sick public utilities, a stagnant agricultural base and an irrigation system that has stopped growing



cent in 2022-23 to 6.20 per cent in 2025-26. Second, the buoyancy of state-own tax revenues (SOTR) has remained sub-optimal, which was 7.92 per cent in 2011-12. The new government must investigate why the wealth of the State is not reflecting in its coffers. Is it due to leakages or an over-reliance on a few sectors or a failure to formalise growing segments of the economy? Without fixing this leaky bucket, the government will find it impossible to fund its visionary projects and freebies.

Unlike many other States, Tamil Nadu’s economy is structurally heavily skewed towards the service sector, which hovers around 54 per cent to the GSDP since 2020-21. While this looks good on a balance sheet, it poses a socio-economic problem. The service sector comprising IT, financial services and professional consulting is capital-intensive and skill-heavy.

For the millions at the bottom of the economic pyramid mostly residing in rural areas, the trickle-down effect is

minimal. High-rise tech parks in Chennai or Coimbatore do little to boost the daily wages of a rural labourer in Pudukkottai or a small-scale weaver in Kanchipuram. The disparity between a high GSDP and the stagnant income of the poor is widening. The TVK government must find a way to turn towards labour-intensive manufacturing and value-added agriculture to ensure that growth is inclusive rather than just arithmetic.

AGRICULTURE IN DISTRESS
Nowhere is the crisis more visible than in the agricultural sector over the last five years or so. Despite the State’s overall growth, agriculture has often languished, failing to keep pace with the rest of the economy. While the real growth of GSDP was 8-11 per cent in 2023-24 and 2024-25, the same was negative in agriculture in this period. The State’s monthly income from crop cultivation stands at a meagre ₹2,641, ranking 22 among States as per the latest data. There is a palpable sense of anger among farmers who feel abandoned by the State’s policy framework. Rising input costs, volatile market prices, lack of market support, and absence of institutional support for high-value diversification have pushed the agrarian community to the brink. If the new government does not address this rural discontent, the political honeymoon of TVK could be remarkably short-lived.

Central to the agricultural depression is the irrigation crisis. Irrigated area in

Tamil Nadu has been hovering around 34 lakh hectares since 1970-71; a stagnation that is virtually unmatched by any other major State. While neighbouring Andhra Pradesh and Karnataka have expanded their irrigated area significantly through new projects and rejuvenation of tanks, Tamil Nadu has remained trapped with dependency on dwindling groundwater and inter-State river disputes.

Without improving the irrigated area or modernising the existing irrigation sector through canal and tank restoration, achieving sustained agricultural growth is an impossible dream. The lack of new irrigated area over four decades is a structural failure that the TVK government must now rectify to ensure the State’s food security and rural stability.

To conclude, the path to a golden age for Tamil Nadu is blocked by a mountain of debt, sick public utilities, a stagnant agricultural base and an irrigation system that has stopped growing. To succeed, the new administration must move beyond the allure of populist rhetoric, to the hard reality of rigorous economic management.

This requires a sophisticated balancing act: restructuring debt and improving revenue buoyancy to create fiscal space, while simultaneously pivoting investment towards the long-neglected rural economy.

The writer is an Economist and former full-time Member (Official), Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices, New Delhi. Views are personal

Payment discipline, a must for making ECLGS work

A good credit design alone will not help in ensuring the scheme’s success. The collapse of trade credit must be dealt with

Bhawarlal Chandak

The Cabinet’s approval of ECLGS 5.0 is a timely response to geopolitical stress, rising fuel costs, and supply-chain disruptions affecting MSMEs and aviation. With 100 per cent government-backed guarantees, capped rates, and near-automatic sanctions, the scheme continues the borrower-friendly approach of earlier ECLGS versions.

ECLGS 1.0, launched in May 2020 for MSMEs, was perhaps the most accessible working-capital facility India had ever offered. Loans of up to 20 per cent of outstanding credit were available without collateral, with interest capped at 9.25 per cent for banks, no processing fees, and a 100 per cent sovereign guarantee eliminating credit risk for lenders. Banks were actively reaching out to eligible borrowers. Government machinery was promoting drawdown. Yet, after four rounds of ECLGS, which ended in mid-2023, MSMEs availed of guarantees worth ₹2.45 lakh crore, out of the corpus of ₹5 lakh crore that was set aside. The total sum disbursed was ₹3.6 lakh crore. The reasons for this need to be explored.

MSMEs and traders do not operate on bank credit alone. Their working capital cycle is built on a continuous chain of trade credit — goods and services

supplied on deferred payment terms to buyers ranging from large corporates and distributors to government departments. Bank working capital usually rests on the underlying trade credit system. The MSME’s ability to service any loan depends on the speed and reliability with which its buyers settle dues. Covid-19 disrupted this payment chain and the legacy continues.

In this environment, a well-managed MSME made a rational calculation: borrowing more to extend fresh trade credit into a market already delaying or defaulting on dues would increase liabilities without assurance that the resulting receivables would be recoverable in full or on time.

Banks were, understandably, approaching the problem from a supply-side lens: credit is available, guaranteed, and cheap. MSMEs were approaching it from a receivables’ reality: the problem is not absence of funds — it is absence of collections. This mismatch of perspectives, rather than any design flaw in the scheme, explains much of the utilisation gap.

CHALLENGE FOR ECLGS 5.0
The concern for ECLGS 5.0 is that the post-Covid payment environment has not fully normalised. What began as emergency-driven payment delays gradually shifted behavioural norms — delayed payment and defaults became,



DELAYED PAYMENTS. A major problem area for MSMEs

for many buyers, an accepted working-capital strategy rather than an exceptional measure. When delays cross a critical mass, reputational deterrence weakens: many honest payers cannot be distinguished from defaulters, and no individual firm has an incentive to restore discipline alone. Trade credit, supply-chain financing, bank working capital, and NBFC lending are deeply interconnected; stress in one segment transmits across the system, slowing credit circulation and compressing the credit multiplier.

India is fortunate to already possess the digital infrastructure to address this challenge. GSTN captures invoice-level transaction data across the supply chain. UPI, NEFT, and RTGS generate time-stamped payment trails. The Account Aggregator framework enables consent-based data sharing. What is

needed is one additional architectural step: systematically pairing each accepted invoice with its corresponding digital payment record.

Once a buyer accepts an invoice on GSTN, it becomes a digitally authenticated liability. Linking the related payment details — UTR, date, amount, and mode — to the same invoice creates a verified audit trail where invoices are either matched to payments or flagged as outstanding. Lenders would be able to assess not merely balance sheets, but actual cash-flow behaviour — the true determinant of an MSME’s ability to service debt.

TreDS platforms could price invoice discounting based on verified buyer payment records, reducing financing costs for MSMEs with reliable payers. A transaction-backed credit profile for consistent payers would gradually replace collateral-dependence. ECLGS 5.0 is a well-designed, appropriately targeted scheme.

Its success in the case of MSMEs, however, will ultimately depend on a factor outside its own design: the health of the trade-credit payment ecosystem into which it is released. Credit availability alone, as ECLGS 1.0 demonstrated, does not guarantee credit utilisation.

The writer is former DGM, SIDBI

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Austerity measures

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s has appealed to Indians to defer gold purchases, avoid foreign travel, and reduce oil consumption to save foreign exchange. The appeal comes amid a weakening rupee, rising crude oil prices following the closure of the Strait of Hormuz during the US-Israel conflict with Iran, surging imports, and slowing foreign investment and remittance inflows. The government must present a credible economic roadmap to tackle these challenges. Though India’s forex reserves remain comfortable at nearly \$690 billion,

prolonged crude prices above \$100 per barrel could severely strain fiscal stability. What India needs now is transparent economic management and long-term policy clarity.

M Jeyaram
Sholavandan, TN

Advertisement cost

This refers to 'FMCG giants cut advertising budgets due to slowing demand, rising costs' (May 14). India remains among the world's top spenders on television, print, billboards, and news channel ads. Yet the sheer frequency of repetition

often irritates viewers, undermining the products being promoted. Excessive advertising not only risks alienating consumers but also inflates costs. In fact, ad expenditure is a major component of the Maximum Retail Price (MRP), meaning buyers ultimately foot the bill for campaigns they may not even appreciate. Rationalising ad spend, focusing on relevance rather than saturation, and shifting towards digital or targeted formats could ease costs while preserving consumer trust. Sustainable advertising must balance visibility

with value, not drown audiences in noise. If a product truly resonates with people, advertising becomes secondary. Word of mouth naturally spreads its appeal, as satisfied customers share their experiences with others.

O Prasada Rao
Hyderabad

Tapping gold ETFs

Apropos 'Allow gold ETFs to unlock vaults' (May 14). The article makes a technically sound argument. Allowing gold ETFs to deploy futures alongside physical holdings could

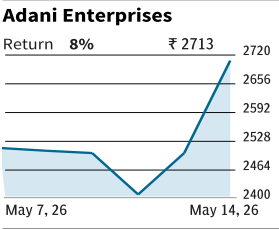
meaningfully reduce import pressure without asking investors to sacrifice exposure. The regulatory groundwork, as the article notes, already exists. What is missing is SEBI's willingness to treat managed futures allocation as standard practice rather than an exception. With 115 tonnes sitting idle in vaults and imports surging, this structural fix deserves faster consideration than it is currently receiving. Tariffs alone will not solve a problem rooted in how Indians save.

Abbharna Barathi
Chennai



QUICKLY.

GQG sells 59 lakh Adani Ent shares for ₹1,435 cr



New Delhi: US-based investment firm GQG Partners on Thursday sold 58.92 lakh shares of billionaire Gautam Adani-led Adani Enterprises for ₹1,435 crore through an open market transaction. Rajiv Jain-backed GQG Partners, through its affiliate GQG Partners Emerging Markets Equity Fund, offloaded a total of 58,92,423 shares, representing a 0.45 per cent stake in Adani's flagship firm Adani Enterprises, as per the block deal data available on the NSE. Shares were disposed of at an average price of ₹2,435.60 apiece, taking the transaction value to ₹1,435.16 crore.

Kotak Alternate invests in Lloyds Metals debentures

Mumbai: Kotak Alternate Asset Managers on Thursday announced a ₹750 crore investment in non-convertible debentures issued by mining company Lloyds Metals and Mining. Kotak Alts' partner Rahul Chhapparwal said the investment is aimed at supporting the mining and metal player's next phase of growth and capacity expansion, while providing a flexible capital solution aligned with its long-term objectives. "We look forward to deepening our relationship with the Lloyds Group and partnering with them as they continue to scale the business," he added. Company's Chairperson Mukesh Gupta said the investment will strengthen its capital base as it continues to scale mining and integrated steel operations.

Kaynes Tech shares hammered after Q4 profit drops 21.5% on rising costs

THUMBS DOWN. JPMorgan and JM Financial downgrade stock citing headwinds in OEM, OSAT business

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Integrated manufacturing company Kaynes Technology missed market expectations as it posted a 21.5 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) decline in net profit for the fourth quarter of FY26 at ₹91.2 crore, compared with ₹116.2 crore in the corresponding quarter last year, impacted by higher raw material and employee costs.

The shares of the company was hammered by 20 per cent on BSE and ended the day at ₹3,339.25.

Raw material costs rose 26.9 per cent during the quarter to ₹848.5 crore, while employee costs increased 94.7 per cent to ₹90.8

Q4 scorecard (₹ crore)			
	Q4FY25	Q4FY26	% change
Net profit	116	91.2	-21.5
Revenue from operation	985	1,243	26.2
EBITDA margin (%)	15.6	17.1	-

crore. However, revenue rose 26.2 per cent y-o-y to ₹1,242.6 crore during the quarter.

On a full-year basis, the company reported a 24 per cent rise in net profit to ₹363.9 crore, while revenue increased 33.2 per cent to ₹3,626.4 crore.

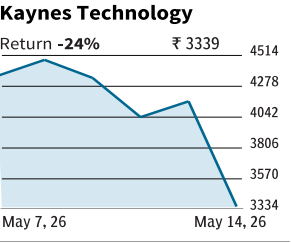
OEM BUSINESS

About 39 per cent of the company's revenue came from OEM turnkey box-build solutions, 43 per cent from OEM turnkey PCBA, while the remaining 18 per cent came

from ODM, product engineering and IoT solutions. The automobile segment was the largest revenue contributor, accounting for 26 per cent of total revenue.

JPMorgan downgraded the stock to 'Neutral' from 'Overweight' and slashed its price target to ₹4,000 from ₹6,000 earlier.

The brokerage cut its earnings estimates for Kaynes Technology by 12 per cent to 17 per cent over the next two years, citing lower expectations from both the core EMS and OSAT businesses.



Brokerage firm JM Financial said that the company had missed FY26 revenue guidance despite several downward revisions, while concerns remain around the sustainability of its FY28 revenue target of ₹8,500 crore, which implies a CAGR of over 50 per cent between FY26 and FY28.

WORKING CAPITAL

The brokerage also highlighted the company's

stretched working capital cycle of 179 days as of March 2026, with receivable days doubling year-on-year.

It said the smart meter business continues to operate on a cycle exceeding one year, with limited chances of near-term normalisation as smart meters are viewed as a major growth opportunity.

JM Financial further flagged continued cash burn, with negative operating cash flow of ₹600 crore in FY26, which could lead to incremental dilution or higher debt to fund the planned capex of over ₹8,000 crore until FY28.

The company's order book stood at over ₹8,000 crore at the end of FY26, providing strong revenue visibility going forward, said Kaynes in its filing to the exchanges.

Sensex, Nifty rally for second straight day as US-China optimism offsets rupee woes

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets extended their rebound for a second consecutive session on Thursday, driven by broad-based buying in pharma, metals and financial stocks, even as the rupee hit a fresh all-time low of 95.96 against the dollar and crude oil remained elevated at around \$105 per barrel.

The Nifty 50 closed at 23,689.60, up 277 points, while the BSE Sensex gained 789.74 points to settle at 75,398.72. The Nifty Midcap 100 rose 1.1 per cent, while the Smallcap 100 ended flat.

Nifty Metal and Nifty Pharma were among the top sectoral gainers, jumping 2 per cent and 2.7 per cent respectively, while the Nifty IT index was the lone laggard, falling nearly 2 per cent, weighed down by concerns

over intensifying global AI competition.

The day's rally was anchored largely by optimism around the ongoing US-China Summit. Aditya Agrawal, CIO, at Avisa Wealth Creators, said that "a constructive US-China Summit could improve global risk appetite, support equities, ease supply chain concerns and strengthen emerging market inflows."

Despite the equity recovery, macro headwinds remained prominent. India's wholesale inflation surged to a 42-month high of 8.3 per cent in April, raising fears of margin pressure and a delayed rate-cut cycle by the RBI. The rupee's slide to record lows and sustained foreign institutional outflows continued to cap the upside, even as domestic institutional investors and retail participation through SIPs provided a partial buffer.

Block deal surge hints at market recovery

Bloomberg

A flurry of block trades is indicating that India's equity capital markets may be in the early stages of a revival after a subdued year so far.

At least half a dozen block trades have been executed over the past week, including a \$782 million sale of Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone stocks by Worldwide Emerging Market Holding Ltd and a \$574 million offering of shares in Groww by Billionbrains Garage Ventures Ltd. Proceeds from such deals have surged to ₹20,000 crore in May, making it the strongest month this year, according to exchange data.

The resurgence of block

trades is injecting a sense of optimism into a capital market that has struggled in 2026 as the underperformance of Indian stocks has made prospective issuers more tentative. IPOs have raised less than \$3.5 billion this year, far short of the previous two record-setting years.

LEAD INDICATOR

"Block trades are often seen as a leading indicator of a broader recovery in deal activity," said V Jayasankar, MD and Deputy CEO at Kotak Investment Banking. "They play a crucial role in price discovery and help rebuild investor confidence after periods of uncertainty, often paving the way for a pickup in IPO activity."

Exchange data show the

transactions were absorbed by a mix of domestic and foreign institutional investors, signalling steady demand for large secondary offerings.

And the block trade activity continued on Thursday. A shareholder sold 5.89 million shares of Adani Enterprises, while 6.15 million Axis Bank shares also changed hands.

Besides, the \$360 million IPO of Bagmane Prime Office REIT was subscribed 23 times last week, indicating pockets of strong investor demand.

If sustained, the recovery in block trades could mark the early stages of a broader revival in India's capital markets and help revive the IPO pipeline in the coming months, echoing trends seen in previous cycles.

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Nifty 50 could potentially scale 42,000 by 2029 if historical flow patterns and domestic growth momentum sustain, said a CNI InfoX-change report after analysing past trends, especially post heavy selling by foreign portfolio investors.

MARKET RESURGENCE

According to the report, *With the Return of FII*, equities have increasingly become flow-driven rather than purely earnings-led over the last several years.

The study noted that nearly \$54 billion in FII in-

flows between 2019 and September 2021 helped power a 63 per cent rally in the Nifty, while another \$45 billion in inflows during July 2022 to September 2024 resulted in a 68 per cent surge in the benchmark index.

Market structure has fundamentally strengthened due to expanding domestic institutional investor participation, systematic investment plan inflows and growing alternative investment fund activity, which have collectively reduced the market's vulnerability to foreign selling. Even during periods of heavy FII outflows, market corrections remained relatively contained, it said.

The report projected that if the country attracts an-



other \$50 billion in FII inflows over the next two years, historical flow-to-return dynamics could push the Nifty toward 40,000-42,000 by 2028-29.

The CNI InfoXchange report highlighted several factors that could support such a rally. These include sustained GDP growth above 7 per cent, supportive RBI policy, large-scale infrastructure and manufacturing re-

forms, strong domestic liquidity and a continued capex cycle backed by government spending.

The report also expects India's weight in the MSCI Emerging Markets Index to rise to 23.5-25 per cent by FY28, potentially overtaking China, while projecting total FPI and FDI inflow potential of \$160-180 billion over FY27 and FY28.

The report said the bull case for Indian equities would require strong earnings growth, continued SIP inflows, a stable inflation environment and supportive global liquidity conditions.

At the same time, the report cautioned that the path to 42,000 will depend heavily on global macro stability.

Bagmane REIT ends 3.7% higher at ₹103.66 on Day 1

Our Bureau
Chennai

Blackstone-backed Bagmane Prime Office REIT ended day 1 of its listing on a strong note, gaining nearly 3.66 per cent at ₹103.66 against the issue price of ₹100. The units were listed at ₹103.40 on the BSE and climbed to a high of ₹104.48.

Earlier, the ₹3,405-crore initial public offering of Bagmane REIT saw a record response from investors as the issue closed with a subscription of 23.71 times.

The portion for other investors fetched 21.87 times subscription, while the portion for institutional investors got subscribed 25.25 times.

The IPO received over 2 lakh applications, the highest ever for a REIT issue. Ahead of the IPO, the



STRONG START. Krishnan Iyer (from left), Senior V-P, NSE; Nagamani Raja and Raja Bagmane, Founder & MD, Bagmane Group, along with Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister DK Shivakumar at the listing ceremony of REIT units

REIT raised ₹1,150 crore from anchor investors. The IPO of the Bengaluru-based real estate investment trust consisted of a fresh issue worth ₹2,390 crore and an offer for sale of ₹1,015 crore by the selling unit holder (Blackstone).

Proceeds will be used to acquire Luxor at Bagmane Capital Tech Park (spanning one million sq ft) as well as

part-fund the acquisition of a 93 per cent stake in Bagmane Rio, which owns the 1.1 million sq ft Bagmane Rio Business Park.

The REIT's portfolio comprises six premium Grade A+ business parks with 20.3 million sq ft total area, and it is located in the world's best performing micro-markets (by net absorption since from CY21 to CY25).

SEBI proposes easing derivatives norms for exchanges, clearing corporations

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Regulator SEBI on Thursday proposed a wide-ranging overhaul of regulations governing exchange-traded derivatives, including commodity derivatives, aimed at simplifying compliance requirements and reducing duplication for exchanges and clearing corporations.

The regulator proposed merging multiple provisions across master circulars, removing outdated norms and streamlining operational requirements for market infrastructure institutions. The aim is "simplification of regulatory requirements, removal of redundant provisions, discontinuation of duplication, in order to promote ease of doing business and reduce the compliance burden on exchanges."

Another key suggestion is removing the "Close to the Money" option series mechanism for options in goods in commodity derivatives, in



line with global commodity exchanges. SEBI said the concept makes exercise mechanisms complex for participants.

PAC NORMS

SEBI has also proposed reducing the mandatory frequency of Product Advisory Committee meetings for non-agricultural commodity derivatives from two meetings a year to one annually, aligning it with norms applicable to agricultural commodities. Exchanges had represented that contract specifications for non-agricultural commodities generally require limited modifications and that participation in such meetings has been

low. Public comments on the consultation paper have been invited till June 4.

Another proposal relates to advancing expiry dates of commodity derivative contracts in case physical markets are shut due to sudden events such as strikes, festivals or erratic weather conditions. "Decision about such advancing expiry of running contract shall be intimated to the trade participants by giving adequate notice before the revised the given circumstances, it is impractical to seek PAC approval for advancing the expiry of a single contract and issue an intimation 10 days in advance," SEBI said.

Exchanges may also be allowed to outsource monitoring of position limits to clearing corporations through formal agreements clearly defining roles and responsibilities and at arm's length. Different exchanges currently follow varying practices for monitoring position limits across products and client categories.

BROKER'S CALL.

Systematix

CIPLA (BUY)

Target: ₹1,732
CMP: ₹1,438.65
Cipla Q4-FY26 Revenue (₹6,541.20 crore -3 per cent y-o-y), EBITDA (₹997 crore down 35 per cent y-o-y) and net earnings (₹554.60 crore down by 55 per cent y-o-y), were below consensus expectations, but above our estimates. Strong growth in India (15 per cent y-o-y) and Africa (21 per cent y-o-y) was offset by sharp decline in North America (-26 per cent y-o-y). 15 per cent growth in India was supported by in licensing deals. The quarter potentially included meaningful contribution from in-licensed assets - Eli Lilly obesity drug and Pfizer portfolio (Corex, Dolonex and Neksium) which together would have contributed about 400-500 bps to y-o-y growth. North America declined owing to loss of high value products like gRevimid and lanreotide discontinuation. EBITDA margins dipped 760bps y-o-y owing to decline in high value assets and increase in R&D investments. R&D costs were higher by 20 per cent y-o-y and stood at 7.8 per cent of sales vs 6.3 per cent of sales in Q4-FY25. Company expects full year EBITDA margins to be in the 18.5-20 per cent range, with margins picking up in the second halfed by ramp up in US. By Q4-FY27, US run rate is expected to reach close to \$250 million (currently \$155 million). We are currently not factoring in the US guidance in our numbers. gVentolin, gAdvair, gSymbicort and teduglutide are the key expected launches. Based on our revised estimates, we retain Buy with a PT of ₹1,732 (25x FY28E EPS).

InCred Equities

CARTRADE (BUY)

Target: ₹2,953
CMP: ₹1,836.20
Car Trade Tech Ltd is India's leading multi-channel digital marketplace, connecting consumers, dealers, OEMs and financial institutions across vehicles, majorly the vehicle buying and selling journey. The company operates a multi-brands model across three complementary segments — Consumer (CarWale and BikeWale), Remarketing (Shriram Automall – SAMIL) and Classifieds (OLX India). With 500+ physical touchpoints, over 15 crore yearly unique users across each platform, and 95 per cent organic traffic, CarTrade operates a capital-light, high-margin platform business — it does not own or transact in vehicles at any point. Revenue grew at a 29 per cent CAGR over FY23-26 to ₹779 crore in FY26, with EBITDA CAGR at 98 per cent to ₹257 crore (with margins expanding from 9 per cent to 33 per cent). In FY26, consolidated revenue grew 22 per cent y-o-y to ₹779 crore, EBITDA grew at 71 per cent y-o-y, and PAT grew 77 per cent y-o-y — a direct read-through of operating leverage on a fixed-cost base. We initiate coverage on Cartrade Tech with a Buy rating and a Target Price of ₹2,953. The company is at a clear inflection — all three segments firing simultaneously, operating leverage converting incremental revenue almost entirely to profit, and a debt-free balance sheet with ₹1,250 crore in cash providing strategic optionality. Execution risks — particularly OLX monetisation pace & OEM spending shift — are factored conservatively into our estimates.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Triveni Turbine (₹578.45): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

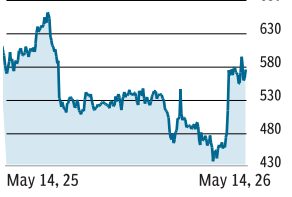
The stock has been consolidating sideways for more than three weeks now. The trading range has been ₹543-₹606. Within this range, the stock touched a low of ₹557 on Wednesday and has risen back well.

It can rise towards the upper end of the range. The broader bias is positive. We expect the stock to make a bullish breakout above ₹606 eventually.

Such a break can take Triveni Turbine share price up to ₹650 and even higher in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Triveni Turbine shares now at ₹578. Accumulate on dips at ₹564.

Triveni Turbine



Keep the stop-loss at ₹542 initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹585 as soon as the price goes up to ₹595. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹598 and ₹620 when the price touches ₹615 and ₹630 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹640.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23739 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23670	23580	23810	23900	Go long on a break above 23810. Keep the stop-loss at 23780

₹770 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
760	748	780	795	Go long only above 780. Stop-loss can be kept at 776

₹1094 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1070	1050	1100	1120	Take fresh shorts now. Keep the stop-loss at 1105

₹307 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
305	302	309	312	Wait for dips. Go long at 306 with a stop-loss at 304

₹301 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
299	296	304	307	Go long now and at 300. Stop-loss can be kept at 298

₹1368 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1350	1330	1380	1400	Go short only below 1350. Keep the stop-loss at 1355

₹982 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
974	964	985	1005	Take fresh longs above 985 with a stop-loss at 982

₹2250 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2200	2150	2275	2310	Wait for a rise. Go short at 2270. Keep the stop-loss at 2785

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
HDFC Bank	769.55	66.57	14.95	10.84	
Bharti Airtel	1883.50	63.11	30.97	5.32	
ICICI Bank	1246.00	16.21	15.40	8.20	
Adani Enter	2712.90	13.43	35.22	0.72	
Cipla	1436.70	13.38	25.60	0.74	
Eternal Ltd	245.82	12.56	648.16	1.63	
M&M	3173.90	12.10	21.19	2.61	
Hindalco	1103.30	9.53	15.42	1.47	
Bajaj Finance	912.15	9.33	29.36	2.25	
Kotak Bank	383.20	8.91	19.76	2.60	
State Bank	579.90	8.87	10.44	3.74	
Sun Pharma	1863.20	8.87	40.82	1.82	
L&T	3940.40	6.30	28.60	4.26	
NTPC	396.30	6.05	15.48	1.73	
ITC	307.20	5.78	18.59	2.73	
Adani Ports	1773.40	5.73	31.97	1.20	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1303.60	5.09	26.17	0.73	
Bajaj Auto	10451.00	4.57	27.62	1.07	
JSW Steel	1296.90	4.50	40.84	1.12	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	935.10	4.44	21.95	1.21	
Reliance Ind	1361.80	4.42	19.25	8.47	
Titan	4135.20	4.00	72.35	1.57	
Max Healthcare	10949.55	3.89	71.97	0.72	
ONGC	900.90	3.18	8.42	1.06	
UltraTech Cement	11692.00	3.07	42.08	1.27	
SBI Life	1866.70	2.86	75.79	0.77	
Tata Steel	221.13	2.72	30.26	1.68	
Apollo Hosp	8119.00	2.57	62.57	0.77	
Trent Ltd.	4132.40	2.32	85.34	0.84	
HDFC Life	612.55	2.29	69.11	1.31	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	234.13	1.92	95.30	0.71	
Eicher Motors	7034.00	1.88	36.02	0.89	
Bajaj Finserv	1740.20	1.42	14.16	0.92	
IntGlobal eVai	4280.50	1.22	51.54	0.89	
Tata Motors PV	338.75	0.87	46.07	0.65	
Bhavit Elec	424.85	0.47	52.72	1.41	
Asian Paints	2622.20	0.45	64.33	1.09	
Wipro	188.30	0.31	14.89	0.50	
PowerGrid Corp	301.75	0.25	18.08	1.26	
Grasim Ind	2938.70	-0.57	21.11	1.03	
Axis Bank	1254.60	-0.69	14.69	3.31	
Maruti Suzuki	13075.00	-0.80	28.04	0.86	
Tata Consumer/Product	12238.00	-0.95	78.58	0.74	
Hero Cycles	146.60	-1.45	88.44	1.98	
Unilever Hind	2248.70	-3.60	49.93	1.84	
Coal India	4504.00	-4.06	90.01	0.95	
Tech Mahindra	1343.40	-4.37	27.39	0.78	
HCL Tech	1120.44	-4.42	18.32	1.09	
TCS	2246.00	-5.97	16.43	2.11	
Infosys	1095.00	-21.48	15.07	3.53	

Chennai: Chennai-based Redington reported a consolidated net profit of ₹288 crore for the fourth quarter ended March 31 — a 69 per cent drop from the ₹18 crore the company posted in the same quarter last year. Revenue from operations for the quarter stood at ₹33,213 crore, representing year-on-year growth of 25.6 per cent. The jump in losses was driven by impairment losses from one of company's subsidiaries in Türkiye, Redington said in an exchange filing. **OUR BUREAU**

They underscored their mutual intention to continue coordinating approaches in multilateral formats—at the UN, as well as the SCO, BRICS and the G20. Russian President Vladimir Putin is expected to visit India in September this year to attend the annual BRICS Summit.

Speaking before the CLP meeting, he said: "I see this responsibility as a divine calling. It is not a personal gain. The AICC has helped us to make this success a reality. Everything was coordinated by AICC general secretary KC Venugopal. Our former Opposition leader (Chennithala) is my leader... We want to make new Kerala a reality. A person alone cannot deliver anything; only teamwork will do."

Amit Pabari, MD, CRP, a senior advisor at Forex Advisors, said the rupee had now weakened more than 6 per cent against the US dollar since the West Asia conflict began, making it Asia's worst-performing currency in 2026 so far.

Hybrid sovereign models that combine on-premises infrastructure and sovereign cloud environments with broader ecosystem access are emerging as the preferred deployment approach, per the report.

QUICKLY.

ED freezes assets in PMLA case against Gameskraft

New Delhi: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has frozen ₹526 crore bank deposits and seized gold jewellery worth ₹3.5 crore, along with ₹11 lakh in cash, after it concluded searches in a money laundering case against online gaming platform Gameskraft, officials said on Thursday. The searches against the company were launched on May 7 in Delhi-NCR and Bengaluru. The raids concluded on May 13.

CBI searches 7 premises in Reliance Comm fraud case

New Delhi: The Central Bureau of Investigation conducted searches at seven premises on Thursday in connection with a fraud case against Reliance Communications Ltd. The searches took place in Mumbai, Gurugram and Bengaluru at the residential premises of the then CEO, CFO and directors of the company who served between 2015-2017, a CBI spokesperson said.

HAL Q4 net profit surges 6% to ₹4,196 crore



Bengaluru: Hindustan Aeronautics Ltd (HAL) has posted a consolidated net profit of ₹4,196 crore, up 6 per cent y-o-y for the fourth quarter of FY26. The company's revenue stood at ₹13,942.4 crore, up 1.7 per cent. Other income rose sharply by 76.6 per cent to about ₹1,151 crore, increasing the company's overall profitability. For the full year FY26, HAL's consolidated profit rose 9 per cent y-o-y to ₹9,115.52 crore.

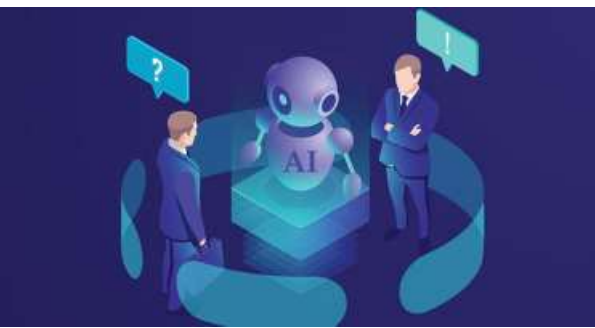
US and China seek guardrails for most powerful AI models

URGENT NEED. Will set up protocol for best practices to keep away non-state bad actors

Reuters
Washington

US and Chinese delegations are discussing artificial intelligence guardrails at their Beijing summit and will set up a protocol for best practices to keep non-state bad actors from exploiting the most powerful AI models. US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent told CNBC in a pre-recorded interview on Thursday that it was “of utmost importance” that the US maintain its lead over China in AI, adding that this is why Beijing is interested in discussing guardrails.

HIGHEST SAFETY “What we don’t want to do is stifle innovation. So our responsibility is to come up with the highest performance calculus where we can get the most innovation and the highest level of safety,”



IN THE WORKS. The US Treasury has been working with the 11 largest banks to ensure that they patch vulnerabilities

Bessent said. The talks come as Anthropic’s powerful new Mythos AI tool has exposed major software security vulnerabilities, prompting banks and other companies to make urgent repairs and software upgrades to correct weaknesses in their networks. Government officials have raised alarms about non-state, criminal or terrorist

organisations exploiting Mythos to disrupt markets and the global financial system. The US Treasury has been working with the 11 largest banks to ensure that they patch vulnerabilities and will do the same with smaller “super-regional” banks and with community banks, Bessent said, adding that he was confident of a “smooth

transition” to AI’s new capabilities. He said that he did not think there would be discussions with China on AI if China was leading the technology race. “So we’re going to put in US best practices, US values on this, and then roll those out to the world,” he said of the AI models. Bessent also expects a large Boeing order during the China visit. He said that the two sides would discuss other purchases, including of energy and agricultural goods, as well as non-strategic, non-sensitive areas in which China could invest in the US. He pushed back against a suggestion that Trump was seeking some \$1 trillion in investment by China, saying, “I’m not sure where this \$1 trillion investment number has come from.”

US clears H200 chip sales to 10 Chinese firms as Nvidia CEO seeks breakthrough

Reuters

The US has cleared around 10 Chinese firms to buy Nvidia’s second-most powerful AI chip, the H200, but not a single delivery has been made so far, three people familiar with the matter said, leaving a major technology deal in limbo as CEO Jensen Huang seeks a breakthrough in China this week. Huang, who was not initially listed in a White House delegation to Beijing, joined the trip after an invitation from President Donald

Trump, a source said. Trump picked him up in Alaska *en route* to a summit with Chinese President Xi Jinping, raising hopes that the trip could finally unlock stalled efforts to sell the H200 chips in China.

TECH RIVALRY The stakes are significant, highlighting how the US-China tech rivalry is now snarling even approved trade, leaving the world’s most valuable company and dominant chipmaker caught between duelling national priorities.

Before US export curbs tightened, Nvidia commanded about 95 per cent of China’s advanced chip market. China once accounted for 13 per cent of its revenue, and Huang has previously estimated that the country’s AI market alone would be worth \$50 billion this year. The US Commerce Department has approved around 10 Chinese companies including Alibaba, Tencent, Byte Dance and JD.com to purchase Nvidia’s H200 chips, according to the sources.

TN CM urges Modi to remove duty on cotton import

Our Bureau
Chennai

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Thursday urged Prime Minister Narendra Modi to remove the import duty on cotton to ensure the availability of raw material to garment manufacturers.

“Of late, the industry is facing severe crisis due to an increase in cotton price and consequently yarn prices. I understand this is caused primarily due to shortage of cotton production and increase in trading activity in the country,” Vijay said in a letter. The price of cotton has increased from ₹54,700 to ₹67,700 per candy, which is a 25 per cent increase during the last two months while yarn price has increased from ₹301 to ₹330 per kg. In this situation, the continued supply of raw material can be ensured only through imports. However, there is an import duty of 11 per cent. Permitting duty-free cotton imports will help the industry meet increasing export commitments, the letter said.

Apollo Tyres net profit increases three-fold to ₹631 crore on strong domestic demand, tax gains

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Strong growth in the domestic replacement and original equipment segments, especially a more than 20 per cent rise in truck-bus radial sales, along with gains from the remeasurement of deferred tax liabilities, helped Apollo Tyres post a more than three-fold jump in consolidated net profit for the fourth quarter ended March 31. The firm on Thursday reported a consolidated net profit of ₹631 crore for Q4 FY26, compared with ₹185 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous financial year.

Q4 performance			
	Q4 FY26	Q4 FY25	% Change
Net Profit	631	185	241.0
Revenue	7,336	6,424	14.0
EPS (Basic) (₹)	9.97	2.91	242.6

Consolidated revenue from operations rose 14 per cent year-on-year to ₹7,336 crore during the quarter, as against ₹6,424 crore in the year-ago period, reflecting sustained demand momentum in the domestic market. Consolidated revenue from operations rose 14 per cent year-on-year to ₹7,336 crore during the quarter, as against ₹6,424 crore in the year-ago period, reflecting sustained demand momentum in the domestic market. “Our performance in India remained robust, particularly in the replacement and original equipment segments,

while recording growth of over 20 per cent in Q4. Our European operations performed in line with prevailing market conditions,” Onkar Kanwar, Chairman, Apollo Tyres, said. “While ongoing geopolitical tensions in West Asia continue to pose headwinds, the company remains optimistic about sustained demand momentum in India, supported by positive rural

sentiment,” Kanwar added. For the full year FY26, consolidated net profit rose 22.3 per cent y-o-y to ₹1,372 crore from ₹1,121 crore in the previous fiscal, while consolidated revenue from operations increased 9 per cent to ₹28,471 crore from ₹26,123 crore in FY25. The Board has recommended a final dividend of ₹2.50 per equity share of face value ₹1 for FY26, subject to shareholder approval at the upcoming annual general meeting. This is in addition to the interim dividend of ₹3.50 per share already paid during the year, taking the total dividend for FY26 to ₹6 per share.

Thomas Cook India revenue falls 11% on weak bookings

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Forward booking pipeline has softened amid a volatile business environment, Thomas Cook India Managing Director and CEO Mahesh Iyer said. While the tour operator continues to see demand for domestic and short haul trips, Iyer cautioned that in the short term these segments will not compensate for the large volume it gets from the long haul sector. Thomas Cook India saw a

11 per cent year-on-year decline in revenue in the fourth quarter FY26 as the West Asia conflict resulted in travel disruption. Revenue in Q4 FY26 stood at ₹1,805 crore compared to ₹2,022 crore in the same period last year. Consolidated profit before tax (prior to exceptional items) declined to ₹47 crore as against ₹91 crore in the fourth quarter FY25. **CAUTION CONTINUES** Iyer said the current business environment is volatile, and customer sentiment remains low. The company,

however, is leveraging partnerships and technology for growth. “We continue to create offerings both from product and pricing perspective while being mindful of the elevated input costs,” Iyer said in post-result conference call on Wednesday. He said the company is focused on prudent revenue management and cost optimisation. Thomas Cook India is also focusing on domestic business with new offerings in spiritual and adventure tourism. Highlighting a recent

initiative, Iyer said the company’s charter flights to Bhutan were sold. “Short haul destinations have become preferred choice,” he added. The company’s destination management business (which handles inbound tours), however, has seen a decline, especially in the Gulf market. Iyer said the foreign exchange business is seeing strong growth. Expansion in new markets and omnichannel strategy helped the company drive growth in forex business in the retail category.

PITTI ENGINEERING LIMITED									
CIN: L29253TG1983PLC004141 Regd. Office: 6-3-648/401, IV Floor, Padmaja Landmark, Somajiguda, Hyderabad - 500082 website: www.pitti.in, e-mail: shares@pitti.in, Telephone: 040 23312774									
EXTRACT OF AUDITED (CONSOLIDATED AND STANDALONE) FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH 2026									
(₹. IN LAKHS)									
PARTICULARS	Consolidated				Standalone				
	Quarter Ended 31.03.2026 Audited	Quarter Ended 31.03.2025 Audited	Year Ended 31.03.2026 Audited	Year Ended 31.03.2025 Audited	Quarter Ended 31.03.2026 Audited	Quarter Ended 31.03.2025 Audited	Year Ended 31.03.2026 Audited	Year Ended 31.03.2025 Audited	
Total Income	50,559.56	47,230.03	195,291.37	174,336.01	39,366.68	42,529.41	162,890.18	56,295.81	
Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3,748.00	4,218.73	16,758.11	16,160.17	3,265.54	3,372.03	14,030.79	14,049.02	
Net Profit for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	3,748.00	4,218.73	16,758.11	16,160.17	3,265.54	3,372.03	14,030.79	14,049.02	
Net Profit for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	2,661.34	3,613.71	11,780.75	12,228.63	2,263.80	2,997.75	9,752.55	10,683.47	
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income(after tax)]	2,468.19	3,622.17	11,668.48	12,167.79	2,009.30	2,948.38	9,596.51	10,685.35	
Equity Share Capital	1,883.10	1,883.10	1,883.10	1,883.10	1,883.10	1,883.10	1,883.10	1,883.10	
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet			96,806.85	87,982.40			93,252.45	86,499.96	
Earnings Per Share (Face Value of ₹5/- each) (not annualised)									
a) Basic	7.21	9.61	31.77	33.32	6.13	7.97	26.30	29.11	
b) Diluted	7.21	9.61	31.77	33.32	6.13	7.97	26.30	29.11	
Note:									
1 The above financial results for the quarter and year ended 31st March 2026 has been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meetings held on 14th May 2026. The statutory auditors have issued audit reports with unmodified opinion on the above results.									
2 The Board of Directors have recommended a final dividend of ₹ 2.50/- (50%) per equity share of face value ₹5/- each for the financial year ended 31st March 2026 subject to approval of members of the Company at the ensuing 42nd Annual General Meeting.									
3 The figures of the fourth quarter are the balancing figures between the audited year-end figures and the published results upto the third quarter of the respective financial years.									
4 The above is an extract of the detailed format of the financial results for the quarter and year ended 31st March 2026 filed with the stock exchange under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the standalone and consolidated audited financial results for the quarter and year ended 31st March 2026 are available on www.nseindia.com, www.bseindia.com, the Company's website (https://pitti.in/investor_desk/investors_fr_r.php) and can also be accessed by scanning QR code provided below.									
Place : Hyderabad Date : 14 th May 2026									
For Pitti Engineering Limited Sd/- Sharad B Pitti Founder & Chairman DIN: 00078716									



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